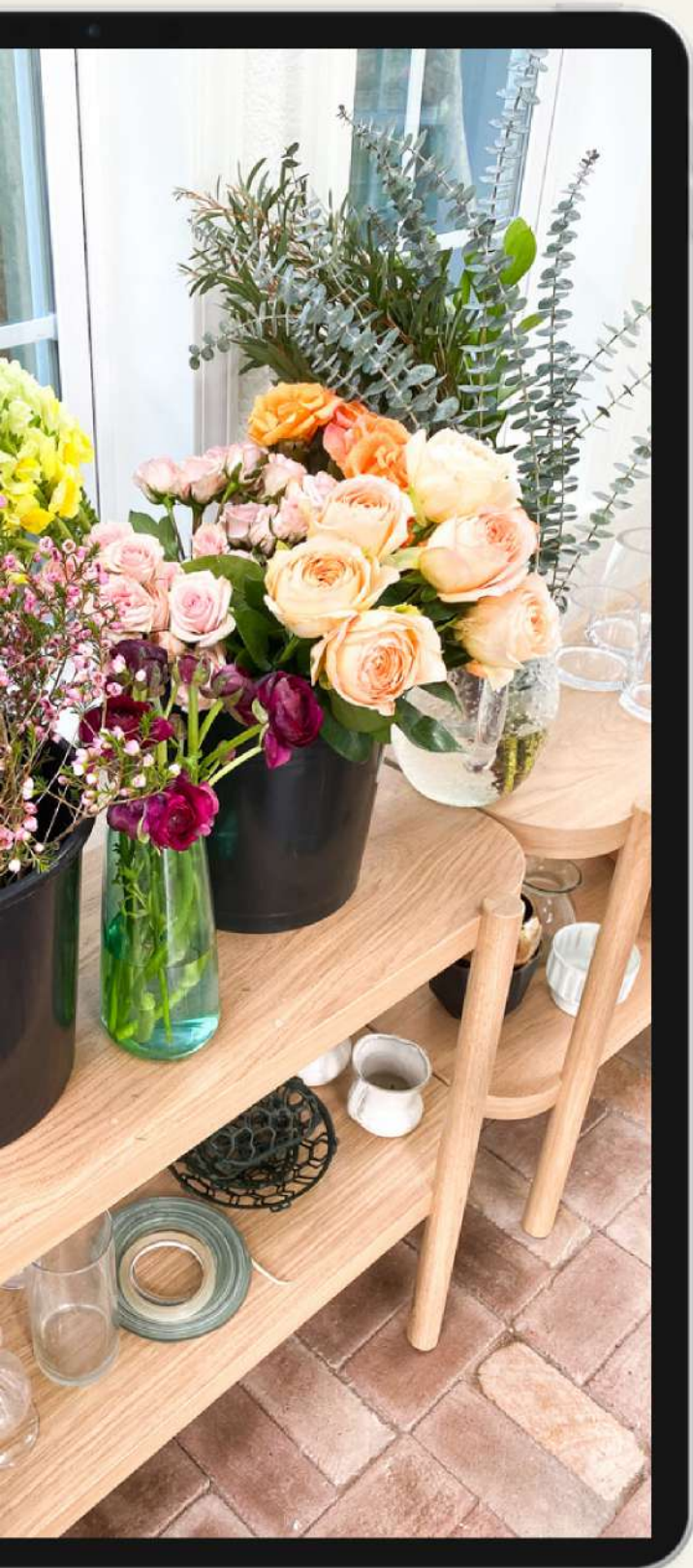




HYDRATION CHANGES EVERYTHING

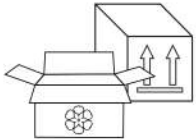
We're going to start this chapter with a HEADS UP: When your flowers are delivered they will look a little weak and sleepy. DO NOT PANIC. This is absolutely normal and we promise you they are not dead! They're just really thirsty! AKA Dying for a drink of water.

Follow our flower prep guidelines below and your blooms will be back to their perky best in a couple of hours.

Simple Flower Prep Steps

MAKE YOUR FLOWERS PRANCY & HYDRATED

key points - what to do when your flowers arrive



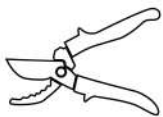
STEP 1: UNPACKAGE & ORGANIZE

Make sure you have your buckets and vases cleaned and filled with 4-5 inches of water before the flowers arrive. Next unbox your flowers and organize them in groups (like with like). Take inventory of all of your flowers compared to your floral order. *any discrepancies or issues must be reported in writing within 24 hours of receiving your order



STEP 2: CLEAN STEMS

You'll want to clean one variety of flower/greenery at a time and take off the unwanted leaves/foliage. I usually clean off most of the leaves on the stems. Watch out for thorns on roses!



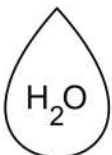
STEP 3: SNIP STEMS

Once the stems are clean, give them a trim with floral snips at a 45 degree angle. If you have longer stems (as with roses) you can trim about 1/4" - 1/2" from the bottom. For shorter stems (ranunculus, tulips, etc) trim about an 1/8" off the bottom. *DO NOT USE SCISSORS!



STEP 4: PLACE IN BUCKET

Once trimmed place the stems in a bucket or vase immediately. You don't want the fresh cut to dry out which inhibits the flowers ability to hydrate. Make sure there are no blooms or leaves below the water line as this promotes the growth of bacteria.



STEP 5: HYDRATE

Once all of your flowers and greenery are in water, make sure they are in a cool dry spot out of the sun. Ideally you want to give them overnight to hydrate (timeline allowing) but if you need to start sooner, give them at least 2-4 hours to hydrate.



STEP 6: PREP WORKSPACE

While your flowers are hydrating and getting some rest, take this time to take inventory of all your supplies and vases you'll need. Make sure you have room for everything and grab any last minute supplies. To protect from the mess you may put a tarp down for easy clean up.

■ UNPACKGE & ORGANIZE - unbox your flowers immediately upon receiving them

Make sure you have your buckets and vases cleaned and filled with 4-5 inches of water before the flowers arrive.

As a rule of thumb, it's good to have at least one bucket or vase per variety of flower and greenery. (Some varieties are temperamental and don't play well with others.)

Here's an example of different size buckets and what you can expect them to hold:

- 1 Large bucket (5 GAL) for 25-50 roses (50 max per bucket)
- 1 Large bucket for 25-50 carnations (50 max per bucket)
- 1 Large bucket for 4-5 bunches of greenery
- 1 Large/tall bucket for Snapdragons, delphinium, larkspur etc. (40 stems max per bucket)
- 1 medium bucket (2.5 GAL) for 10-40 spray roses (40 max)
- Small bucket or vase for delicate blooms and those with shorter stems, such as ranunculus, anemones, tulips, etc. (20 stems max per bucket)

As you start opening boxes, take inventory of all of your flowers compared to your floral order. Most packaging will likely be labeled to help with this task. If you are missing any flowers please email us immediately! See our section [Flower Quality](#) on what to do for discrepancies in your order.

*any discrepancies or issues must be reported in writing within 24 hours of receiving your order

HELPFUL TIP:

Keep the boxes! They'll come in handy for delivering all of your flowers to the ceremony and reception venues!

Start organizing your flowers by grouping like with like; put all your greenery together, all of the same blooms together, similar colors together and so on.

Most flowers will likely be bound at the base with a rubber band or a twist tie and have a plastic and/or cardboard sleeve. Gently remove the plastic sleeve or cover and snip off the rubber band(s) before you start cleaning them stems.

EXCEPTION TO THE RULE:

Except for roses! Leave the cardboard sleeves on all of your roses until after they have finished hydrating. They need the extra support they receive from the cardboard.

■ CLEAN STEMS

You'll want to clean one variety of flower/greenery at a time and take off the unwanted (we say chewy) leaves/foilage/thorns. We recommend cleaning off most of the leaves on the stems. Watch out for thorns on roses

It is not uncommon to see bruised (brown-looking) petals on the outer edges of flowers. These are called guard petals. You can pluck these petals off after the flowers have hydrated or as you are arranging. It doesn't mean the flower is bad!

STEP 2

■ SNIP STEMS

Once the stems are clean, give them a clean cut with floral snips at a 45 degree angle. If you have longer stems (as with roses) you can trim about 1/4" - 1/2" from the bottom. For shorter stems (ranunculus, tulips, etc) trim about an 1/8" off the bottom.

REMINDER: Do NOT use scissors! They are not the right tool for cutting as scissors crush the stems meaning the flowers/greenery won't be able to hydrate properly. Check out our list of, [Bloom Culture-approved snips](#).

STEP 3

■ PLACE IN BUCKET

Once trimmed, place the stems in a bucket of water or vase immediately. Otherwise, the stem end will dry out which inhibits the flower's ability to hydrate. Make sure there are no blooms or leaves below the water line as this can lead to bacteria growth which will damage your flowers.

****Do not overcrowd buckets****
Flowers need ROOM to BLOOM

Make sure all flower heads (aka blooms) are above the bucket or vase edge so they aren't compromised (get smashed, forgotten, accidentally decapitated etc.)

BONUS TIP: Take masking tape and label your buckets as you process the flowers! This makes it easier to know the flowers in the buckets and helpers can easily find the flowers they need! Varieties are labeled on the packaging.

STEP 4

■ HYDRATE

Once all of your flowers and greenery are in water, make sure they are in a cool, dry spot out of the sun. Ideally you want to give them overnight to hydrate (if your timeline allows) but if you need to start sooner, give them at least 2-4 hours to hydrate.

The beauty of your flowers hydrating is that they will start to open up and look even more beautiful! This is also why we suggest having your flowers arrive 3 days before your wedding or event; so they're in their prime on the most important day!

STEP 5

■ PREP & ORGANIZE WORKSPACE

While your flowers are hydrating and getting some rest, take this time to take inventory of all your supplies and vases you'll need. Make sure you have enough supplies for all of your helpers as it stinks to wait to use something. Protect your tables/chairs with tarps/shower curtains, or towels. Consider putting a tarp under the table/workspace to catch all the stems that will surely be flying!

STEP 6

■ IN CASE YOU WERE WONDERING...

Will the flowers need to be in a cooler?

One word - Nope! Keep them in a cool dry place out of the sun. The only exception to this is when you need blooms to open up more. In this instance you can place them near a window or outside, if the temperature is appropriate, not above 80 degrees.

What if my flowers are not in great shape?

This is rare but can happen. We have some flower hacks to help get them perked up and feeling sassy again. Not every flower will be perfect and a loss of 1-3 stems per bunch is normal. (We account for this when we help you with your quantities when ordering.)

If you feel they are not salvageable you'll need to [contact us](#) within 24 hours of receiving your shipment to get a full or partial refund. We will not refund any product that was not properly hydrated or given time to hydrate. See our full policy [here](#).

FAQ'S